

RUSSIAN COMPLEMENT CLAUSES AS INFORMATION STRUCTURE MARKERS: TOPICALIZATION AS A TRIGGER FOR SEMANTIC AND SYNTACTIC CHANGES

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This article focuses on the special use of Russian complement clauses. In this use, clauses with complementizers and infinitive clauses are used as information structure markers — topicalizers. The fact that the clause is marked by the subordination marker serves to point to its status as a topic that is not a part of the main assertion. I show that in the topicalized use, the main complement clauses types lose their main property: the tight link to the matrix predicate and combinational restrictions on the matrix predicate class. The second — syntactically main — part of the sentence often either does not contain a matrix verb or contains a verb incompatible with the given type of complement. The emergence of the topicalized uses is explicable but not reducible to the properties of complement clauses. In fact, the topic position is not characteristic of complement clauses. However, the subordinate clause is topicalized due to the fact that complement clauses — just as topics — usually do not constitute the main assertion. I consider three complement clause types: with infinitive, the markers *čto* and *čtoby* — and show that the particularities of each complement clause type are reflected in its behavior as a topicalizer.

1. Предисловие

Когда я учился на четвертом курсе в нашем Институте лингвистики РГГУ, Вера Исааковна читала у нас спецкурс «Типология полипредикативных конструкций». Хотя это был курс по выбору и слушали его только желающие, для меня это был один из самых интересных курсов за всё время обучения. При этом в то время я считал, что сам не буду заниматься полипредикативными конструкциями — меня интересовали совсем другие темы.

Однако, наверное, не случайно, что позже я все-таки свернул именно к этой области. Никто не знает, как все повернётся через несколько лет, но такие учителя, как Вера Исааковна, всегда влияют на твой выбор, даже если ты не осознаешь этого сразу.

2. Introduction

Russian has a rich system of complementizers. It includes the real complementizer *čto*, the irreal *čtoby*, and the infinitive as the third element. However, the system also contains some peripheral complementizers, such as *kak by* (the apprehensive complementizer with verbs like *bojat'sja* 'be afraid' and *sledit'* 'watch out'); *kogda* 'when' and *esli* 'if' used as complementizers with factive verbs in unreal contexts; the immediate perception complementizer *kak*, and so on. The Russian system appears to be richer than its counterparts in West Slavic and South Slavic relatives (see Hansen et al. 2016 for the sketch of the Slavic complementizer system).

This paper focuses on cases where complement clauses are left-dislocated and are topics, while the second part constitutes a focus. Their principal feature is that the second part of the sentence either contains no matrix predicate or this predicate is incompatible with the given complementation strategy in the canonical use.

Note that Rizzi (1997) points to the relevance of information structure for the syntax. However, research of topicalized phrases mainly concerns nominal arguments and rarely takes into account the behavior of complement clauses.

I will briefly describe constructions with three types of complement clauses in the topic position: infinitive complements (Section 3), complements with the complementizers *čtoby* (Section 4) and *čto* (Section 5). In the last sections, I will analyze some relevant properties of topicalized complement clauses.

3. Infinitive in the topic position

Infinitive complements are often found in the leftmost position of the sentence, before the main clause. In those cases, infinitive is usually a topic. As Diessel and Schmidtke-Bode (2017) show, infinitive allows left dislocation and other dislocation types easier than any type of finite complement clauses. Some of these left-dislocated infinitive constructions differ from postposed infinitives only by the linear position, but others get specific properties that usual postposed infinitives lack.¹

¹ It should also be noted that in most examples, the topicalization is supported by the use of anaphoric elements, such as *eto* 'this', *tak* 'so', or *takoe* 'such'. This may prove that the topicalized clause is not in fact an argument of the matrix verb, while the anaphoric element is really an argument. However, I will not discuss it here in detail.

In (1), the infinitive clause can be regarded as a left-dislocated complement clause of the matrix verb *xotet'* 'want', which also takes infinitive complements in the regular position after the matrix verb. Another type of use is found in examples like (2) and (3), where infinitive clauses participate in copula constructions.

- (1) *Ssori-t'-sja, èt-ogo ja ne xoč-u.*
 quarrel-INF-REFL this-N.SG.GEN I.NOM NEG want-PRS.1SG
 'I do not want this, to quarrel.'
- (2) *A pi-t' èt-o ot lukav-ogo.*
 and drink-INF this-N.SG.NOM from devil-SG.GEN
 'And to drink, it is from the devil.' (<https://www.ridus.ru/kadyrov-predlozhl-vvesti-v-rossii--suhoj-zakon--5534.html>)
- (3) *Sudi-t'-sja èt-o kogda est' kak-ie-nibud' somnenij-a.*
 sue-INF-REFL this-N.SG.NOM when be.PRS.3SG some-PL.NOM doubt-PL.NOM
 'Suing is for cases when there are some doubts.' (Andrei Volos. Ned-
 vižimost')

The specific nature of topicalized left-dislocated infinitives is shown in example (4a). In this example, the second part contains a complement-taking predicate, but it is a verb *ponimat'* 'understand' that is normally incompatible with infinitive complements. This is also the case with the matrix verb *odobrjat'* 'approve' in the second part of (4b).

- (4) a. *A už na detsk-ie_ploščadk-i žalova-t'-sja*
 and PART on playground-PL.ACC complain-INF-REFL
èt-o ja ne ponimaj-u.
 this-N.SG.ACC I.NOM NEG understand-PRS.1SG
 'And to complain about playgrounds — I don't understand it.'
 (<https://lubernet.ru/id/19/show/posts/sid/17329/page/1/>)
- (4) b. *Opozda-t' i podves-ti druž-ej*
 be.late-INF and let.down-INF friend-PL.ACC
tak-ogo ja ne odobraj-u.
 such-N.SG.ACC I.NOM NEG approve-PRS.1SG
 'I do not like it: to be late and to let your friends down — I do not like it.'

The special property of infinitive topics is that they denote a **generalized situation**, something like a label of the situation. This generalized use is sometimes observed for infinitive in the usual position but becomes the main

one in the topic position. Note that the topicalized infinitive construction does not fall into the class of standard constructions with PRO, controlled from the matrix clause, because no plausible controller of the null infinitive subject can be found in (4a) and (4b).

4. *Čtoby* in the topic position

The complementizer *čtoby* has a discourse use different from the use of infinitive. While the latter mainly denotes a generic action, *čtoby* has an additional modal flavor. Its meaning in the topic position can be termed 'generic hypothetical situation': not only it denotes a generic type of situations, the truth value of the proposition is discussed: the situation can be either realized or remain unreal.

- (5) ['There are plenty of beautiful and famous people I know.']
No vot tak čtoby vzja-t' i upas-t' u menja tak-ix net.
 but PART so to take-INF and fall-INF at I.GEN such-PL.GEN no
 'But there are no people which would make me fall [i.e., to be completely fond of them].'
 (<https://www.woman.ru/beauty/medley2/thread/5301845/>)

In (5), the situation 'fall' is not simply generic, but also taken to be unreal: it is introduced in the topic, and then shown to be false in the second part of the sentence.

Again, some of topicalized uses of *čtoby* cannot be regarded as a left-dislocated complement clause: for instance, (6) is hardly possible if the complement clause is postposed, as in (6'), because *čtoby* in the topic use can be used even with predicates and constructions that do not take this complementizer in the regular postpositive position.

- (6) *No vot čtoby cel-uju knig-u ses-t' i počita-t' ne*
 but PART COMP whole-F.SG.ACC book-SG.ACC sit-INF and read-INF NEG
bud-et emu daže v golov-u ne prihod-it èt-a mysl'-Ø.
 be-FUT.3SG he.DAT even in head-SG.ACC NEG come-PRS.3SG this-F.SG.NOM idea-SG.NOM
 'But to sit down and to read the whole book — he will not, he does not even have this idea.' [коллективный. Чтение книг и 7-летний ребенок (2015.01.20)]
- (6') **On ne bud-et čtoby cel-uju knig-u počita-t'.*
 he.NOM NEG be-FUT.3SG COMP whole-F.SG.ACC book-SG.ACC read-INF
 Intended: 'He will not for / to read the whole book.'

- (7) *No vot čtoby kak Ruslik-Ø vygryza-t' iz mirozdanij-a*
 but PART COMP like Ruslik-SG.NOM snatch-INF from fate-SG.GEN
neponjatno kak-oe blagopoluči-e — net!
 incomprehensible which-N.SG.ACC wealth-SG.ACC no
 'But to snatch from the fate some wealth of an unclear type, as Ruslik does — no!' [Н. Б. Черных. Слабые, сильные. Часть первая // «Волга», 2015]
- (8) *No vot čtoby menja presledova-l-Ø strax-Ø smert-i*
 but PART COMP I.ACC chase-PST-M.SG fear-SG.NOM death-SG.GEN
èt-ogo net.
 this-N.SG.GEN no
 'But that I suffer from the fear of death — no, that's not true.' [Галина Волчек. «Верю во взаимность во всем, не только в любви» // «Огонек», 2013]
- (9) *No vot čtoby on tak lopnu-l-Ø čto cen-a*
 but PRT COMP he.NOM so burst-PST-M.SG COMP price-SG.NOM
upa-l-a niže 50 dollar-ov ob èt-om
 fall-PST-F.SG lower 50 dollar-PL.GEN about this-N.SG.LOC
èkspert-y predpočita-l-i ne duma-t'.
 expert-PL.NOM prefer-PST-PL NEG think-INF
 'But that it will burst, so that the price will fall under 50 dollars... the experts preferred not even to think about it.'

4.1. Reality and polarity

In most cases, the polarity of the *čtoby*-clause is affirmative, while the main clause is negative. This allows to regard the topicalized clause with *čtoby* as a type of irrealis marking. The structure is as follows: first, the hypothetical situation is marked in the clause with *čtoby*; second, the possibility of the situation is denied. This is why the second part often contains either the negation marker *ne* or the negative form of the verb *byt'* 'be' *net*: a frequent meaning of the construction is a pure denial of existence, not the irreality of a particular situation.

The negation is not always overt — in examples like (10)², a covert negation is used: without a second part, the *čtoby*-construction looks like a surprise expression, but in the full form, it would contain something like *neverojatno* 'unbelievable', *vrjad li* 'hardly', and so on.

² Note that (10) is a non-standard example in another respect: its second part is a question, and this makes the truth value of the topicalized proposition doubtful.

- (10) *Kto-to govori-l-Ø emu odnaždy čto na zvezd-ax*
 someone.NOM tell-PST-M.SG he.DAT once COMP on star-PL.LOC
est' žizn'-Ø. No vot čtoby na sam-om neb-e?
 be.PRS.3SG life-SG.NOM but PART COMP on self-SG.LOC sky-SG.LOC
 'Someone has once told him that there may be life on stars. But on the sky itself?'

4.2. Another topicalization pattern: irreal *čtoby*

In another type of constructions with a topicalized *čtoby*-clause, the situation is understood as irreal, but not necessarily impossible. In (11) and (12), the situations denoted by topicalized clauses are hypothetically possible, but their reality is doubted.

- (11) *No vot čtoby Lenjka-a k nemu bol'she ne lez —*
 but PART COMP Lenjka-SG.NOM to he.DAT more NEG bother.PST.M.SG
èt-o by-l-o by da.
 this-N.SG.NOM be-PST-N.SG IRR yes
 'But it would be great if Lenjka did not bother him!' [Андрей Геласимов. Степные боги (2008)]
- (12) *A vot čtoby učitelj-a učastvova-l-i v igr-e*
 and PART COMP teacher-PL.NOM participate-PST-PL in game-LOC
na den'g-i tak-ogo učitelj-a
 on money-PL.ACC such-M.SG.ACC teacher-SG.ACC
ljub-a by škol-a vygna-l-a.
 any-F.SG.NOM IRR school-SG.NOM dismiss-PST-F.SG
 'Any school at any time would dismiss a teacher who would play with his pupils on money.' [Форум: Обсуждение фильма «Уроки французского» (1978) (2007-2011)]

Contrary to the first type, this type of *čtoby*-construction does not point to the fact that the topicalized situation is not realized. In (11), the situation may come true, and in (12), its reality status is irrelevant: more relevant is that teacher's participation in the game would be condemned.

5. *Čto* in the topic position

Clauses with the complementizer *čto*, with the semantic of real situation, can also be topicalized. For this marker, topicalization also creates a special use

different from the canonical use in the position after the matrix verb. Of course, there are examples where the only difference is in the topic vs. focus status.

- (13) *Čto on uxod-it my uže zna-l-i.*
 COMP he.NOM leave-PRS.3SG we.NOM already know-PST-PL
 'That he is leaving, we already knew.'

- (14) *My uže zna-l-i čto on uxod-it.*
 we.NOM already know-PST-PL COMP he.NOM leave-PRS.3SG
 'We already knew that he was leaving.'

In examples like (13) and (14), *čto* introduces a clause dependent upon the matrix verb *znali* '(we) knew'. However, there is another use where *čto* functions as a topic marker but is not linked to any matrix verb.

- (15) *A čto on p'jan-yj tak mnogo li v èt-u*
 and COMP he.NOM drunk-M.SG.NOM PART many Q in this-F.SG.ACC
noč'-Ø v gorod-e trezv-yx?
 night-SG.ACC in city-SG.LOC sober-PL.GEN
 'He is drunk? But are many people of the city sober this night?'
 (<https://eressea.ru/library/library/usheltsy.shtml>)
- (16) *A čto negramotn-yj tak èt-o vopros-Ø*
 and COMP illiterate-M.SG.NOM PART this-N.SG.NOM question-SG.NOM
k ix vnutrenn-emu układ-u.
 to their internal-M.SG.DAT traditions-SG.DAT
 'Yes, he is illiterate, but this results from their traditions.'
 (<https://dpmmax.livejournal.com/648631.html>)

Although the semantic and pragmatic properties of topicalized clauses with *čto* differ from that of *čto*by, they have much in common. The common feature of two clause types is the semantic or pragmatic conflict between the clauses, the embedded one containing *čto*(by) and the postposed main one. In both cases, the content of embedded clause is described as irrelevant or irreal in the second part. However, while in constructions with *čto*by, the hypothetical situation is marked as impossible and non-realized, with *čto*, the situation is realized but is not important or relevant for the context of conversation. For instance, in (15), the fact that the subject is drunk is not important because everyone drinks. In (16), the fact that the subject is unable to read is prominent and in a sense important but irrelevant for the current topic. While the first part says that he is illiterate, the second part explains his inability to read by the gypsy lifestyle and traditions.

6. Special syntactic properties of the topicalized uses: extension of infinitive use

Both *čto* and *čto*by have some special syntactic properties in their topicalized uses. One of these properties is extensive use of infinitive. With *čto*by in the standard use, infinitive is possible, but in purpose constructions rather than in complement clauses. Normally, *čto*by used as a complementizer is not used with infinitive — in the co-reference contexts, a bare infinitive without a complementizer is used:

- (17) *Ja sobiraj-u-s' (*čto) uexa-t'.*
 I.NOM be.going.to-PRS.1SG-REFL COMP leave-INF
 'I am going to leave.'
- (18) *On prikaza-l-Ø čto by vs-e spa-l-i / ??vs-em spa-t'.*
 he.NOM order-PST-M.SG COMP all-PL.NOM sleep-PST-PL all-PL.DAT sleep-INF
 'He ordered everyone to go to sleep.'³

By contrast, the use of infinitive with topicalized *čto*by is possible and does not require co-reference.

- (19) *No čto by materi-t'-sja na rebenk-a, ja s èt-im*
 but COMP curse-INF-REFL on child-SG.ACC I.NOM with this-N.SG.INS
vpervye stolknú-l-a-s'.
 first.time meet-PST-F.SG-REFL
 'But to curse at a child, I saw it for the first time.'
 (<https://diesel.elcat.kg/index.php?showtopic=66993560&page=2>)

The complementizer *čto* also takes infinitives when topicalized. Importantly, regular postposed uses of *čto* are incompatible with infinitive. However, its topicalized version takes infinitives.⁴

- (20) *a čto narjaža-t'-sja, tak ešče uspej-u, pravo,*
 and COMP dress.up-INF-REFL PART still have.time-PRS.1SG PART

³ It should be mentioned that an addition of the anaphoric element (see footnote 1) may improve the acceptability rate of *čto*by + infinitive in the argument position.

⁴ The distribution of infinitive vs. indicative patterns still remains unclear. The type of situations described by infinitive complements is not coverable by the features 'non-specific' or 'irreal', because in (22), the situation seems to be both real and specific. This issue is complicated also because the infinitive pattern is rather rare.

na svo-em vek-u.
on own-M.SG.LOC life-SG.LOC

‘... and what concerns dressing up, I will have time to do it.’ [К. А. Березкин. Дневник (1949)]

- (21) *A čto isceli-t', tak legko možno. Želtizn-a v*
and COMP cure-INF PART easily possible yellowness-SG.NOM in
glaz-ax mal-aja, opasn-ogo net.
eye-PL.LOC small-F.SG.NOM dangerous-N.SG.GEN NEG
‘And to cure him is easy. His eyes is only a little bit yellow, there is nothing dangerous about it.’ [А. Е. Зарин. Двоевластие (1912)]

- (22) *a čto ruga-t' tak ix brat-a teper'*
and COMP scold-INF PART their brother-SG.ACC now
vezde rugaj-ut.
everywhere scold-PRS.3PL
‘... and what concerns scolding, people like he are now scolded everywhere.’ [Н. С. Лесков. Бесстыдник (1869)]

These facts show that the topicalized use of *čto* is more different from the standard one than the topicalized use of *čto-by*. As mentioned, *čto-by* hosts infinitives in another type of use, namely, when marking purpose:

- (23) *Ona priexa-l-a čto-by poigra-t' v kart-y.*
she.NOM come-PST-F.SG in.order.to play-INF in card-PL.ACC
‘She came to play cards.’

By contrast, *čto* normally is incompatible with infinitives. In (20)–(22), this complementizer is used as a pure topicalizer and almost entirely lacks a complementizer function.

At the same time, in many examples, the extended use of both complementizers with infinitives shows special referential properties of the topicalized clause. It often denotes a generalized situation, the type of situation, such as ‘offend the child’, but not the specific situation. Infinitive is used here not as a co-reference marker, but as a general label of the situation, in cases when the specific place, time and participants of the situation are irrelevant.

7. Why are rules not strict for topicalized complements?

The general tendency, thus, is that in the leftmost topic position, complement clauses can violate the general rules of their use. For instance, they are com-

bined with predicates that are normally incompatible with the particular complement type or exist even without a matrix predicate.

This possibility of rule violation results from the very nature of unlinked topics, as described by Lambrecht (2001). In fact, complement clause in this position are syntactically not complements of the verb in the second part of the sentence, though linked to it in the semantic respect.

Importantly, it may be noted that in many of examples listed above, such as (4) and (8), topicalized complement clauses are further supported by the use of pronominal elements like *étot* ‘this’ or *takoj* ‘such’. In those cases, pronouns, and not complement clauses, really occupy the argument position in the matrix predicate argument structure. At the same time, examples lacking a pronominal element, such as (6), are also found. In any case, the syntactic link between a topicalized complement clause and the matrix predicate is looser than in the standard complementation structure. This fact creates a possibility of violation of the selective restrictions imposed by matrix predicate. This, in turn, results in a change of functions of complement clause markers (the infinitive form and complementizers), which mainly denote semantic features (the reality status and the relevance degree) of the situation itself, and not the type of syntactic relation and head — dependent correspondence.

8. Special uses or simply effects of position?

The peculiarities of the topicalized uses call for a question related to the status of this uses. Should what we describe be regarded as constructions with topicalized complement clauses — with some peculiar features — or a special semantic use of complement clauses?

The answer is different for infinitive clauses and for clauses marked with complementizers. For infinitive, topicalization does not result in the emergence of a special use. It rather simply makes restrictions on infinitive complements less strict but does not change the core properties of these complements.

By contrast, for *čto-by* and, especially, for *čto*, topicalization leads to formation of special uses, which are not reducible to general features of these complementizers. For instance, the generic hypothetical semantics of left-dislocated *čto-by*-complements do not correspond to any regular use of *čto-by* in the position after the matrix predicate. Similarly, *čto* in examples like (15)–(16) and (20)–(22), where it denotes a situation which is considered relevant but

then shown to be irrelevant, is not similar to regular uses of *čto* outside the topicalization context.

9. The source of non-standard uses

The source of topicalized uses may be different for *čto* and *čtoby*. For *čtoby*, the source are non-specific uses like (24):

- (24) *Ne by-l-o tak-ogo čtoby on mnogo cita-l-Ø.*
 NEG be-PST-N.SG such-N.SG.GEN COMP he.NOM much read-PST-M.SG
 'There were no cases when he read much.'

These uses are, in turn, similar to 'irreal' uses of *čtoby* described by Do-brushina (2016) and others. They are mainly compatible with negation contexts:

- (25) *Ne dumaj-u čtoby on zabo-le-l-Ø.*
 NEG think-PRS.1SG COMP he.NOM fall.ill-PST-M.SG
 'I don't think he fell ill.'

Some irreal *čtoby*-clauses can easily be left-dislocated, as in (26)–(28), which is not characteristic of another use of *čtoby*, the 'purpose' one observed with verbs like *xotet'* 'want' in (29) (verbs like *prikazat'* 'order', *predupredit'* 'warn' or *potrebovat'* 'demand, require' host the same type of *čtoby*-clauses):

- (26) *Čtoby menja nakazyva-l-i remn-em ja ne pomn-j-u.*
 COMP I.ACC punish-PST-PL belt-SG.INS I.NOM NEG remember-PRS.1SG
 'I do not remember my parents to hit me with a belt.' [Андрей Гаврю-шенко, Эльвира Савкина. «В детстве я хотел быть царем» // «Дело» (Самара), 2002.04.18]
- (27) *No čtoby tak prjamo ja nikogda tak-ogo ne vide-l-Ø.*
 but COMP so directly I.NOM never such-N.SG.GEN NEG see-PST-M.SG
 'I have never seen (this tendency to be manifested) in such a direct way.'
 [Фазиль Искандер. Сандро из Черема (Книга 3) (1989)]
- (28) *A čtoby star-yj sux-oj ili gnil-oj*
 and COMP old-M.SG.NOM dry-M.SG.NOM or rotten-M.SG.NOM
popa-l-Ø-sja, ja ne vide-l-Ø.
 occur-PST-M.SG-REFL I.NOM NEG see-PST-M.SG
 'I have never seen him to find an old, dried or rotten one.' [Василий Голо-ванов. Остров, или оправдание бессмысленных путешествий (2002)]

- (29) ??*Čtoby on èt-o dela-l-Ø ja ne xoč-u.*
 COMP he.NOM this-N.SG.ACC do-PST-M.SG I.NOM NEG want-PRS.1SG
 Intended: 'I do not want him to do it.'

- (30) ??*Čtoby on zabo-le-l-Ø ja ne dumaj-u.*
 COMP he.NOM fall.ill-PST-M.SG I.NOM NEG think-PRS.1SG
 Intended: 'I do not believe him to be ill.'

The common feature of uses like (26)–(28) and our topicalization contexts is that the situation is regarded as either impossible or hardly possible. Contrary to examples featuring verbs like 'think', 'believe', and so on, the combination of *pomnit'* 'remember' and *videt'* 'see' with *čtoby* always denote a hypothetical situation and the speaker's relation to it (an 'experiential' component 'He has never seen/remembered this type of situation'). As shown above, the meaning of constructions with topicalization like (6)–(9) and (11)–(12) always contains these components of irrealty of the situation.

A possible scenario is illustrated in (31).

- (31) Scenario for *čtoby*:
 First type of use:
 'I do not think that P is realized' → 'What concerns P, I think that it may not be realized'
 Second type of use:
 'I do not think that P is realized' → 'What concerns P, can only hypothesize on the properties of this situation'

The second type of *čtoby*-construction is, thus, not directly related to the irrealty of the situation. However, it describes a non-specific situation, and not a specific occurrence — it is well-known that the non-specificity of the participant is often described as a sort of irrealty. The speaker just proposes the addressee to assume that the situation came true, and it is unknown if it is really the case.

Thus, the irrealty/impossibility semantic component is already present in the base complementizer use.

The topicalized use of *čto* goes back to constructions with matrix opinion and knowledge verbs. Thus, the irrelevance meaning that manifests itself in the construction with topicalization is absent in the source construction. A possible historical scenario looks like in (32).

- (32) Scenario for *čto*:
 'I know P' → 'I know P, but what is relevant is not P' → 'P is irrelevant'

For instance, in (15), repeated here as (33), the speaker first introduces the proposition ‘He is drunk’, but then it turns out to be irrelevant (for the evaluation of the subject), because everyone is drunk this night.

- (33) *A čto on p'jan-yl tak mnogo li v ét-u*
 and COMP he.NOM drunk-M.SG.NOM PART many Q in this-F.SG.ACC
noč'-Ø v gorod-e trezv-yx?
 night-SG.ACC in city-SG.LOC sober-PL.GEN
 ‘He is drunk? But are many people of the city sober this night?’
 (<https://eressea.ru/library/library/usheltsy.shtml>)

10. Topicality: a more detailed account

Examples that were cited in the article show that the notion of topic is not sufficient for the description of the use under analysis. For instance, in (34), the complement clause with *čto* is also a topic, but at the same time, the context illustrates a canonical complementizer use.

- (34) *A čto ty svoloč'-Ø sil'no somnevaj-u-s'.*
 and COMP you.NOM bastard-SG.NOM strongly doubt-PRS.1SG-REFL
 ‘I highly doubt that you are a bastard.’ (<https://yurakolotov.livejournal.com/384820.html>)

This word order is less frequent than the canonical one with the postposed complement clause. However, the syntactic structure seems to be the same. The difference between (34) and non-canonical uses, addressed before, is in the information structure. Complement clauses as information structure markers denote roughly the same value as the Russian markers *čto kasaetsja* ‘what concerns’. Outside Russian, it is similar to French left-dislocated topics (see Lambrecht 1981; 2001, as well as Halla-Aho 2018 for Latin and Westbury 2016 for typological data). Lambrecht (2001) calls this type of topics “unlinked topics” in the sense that they do not have a structural position governed by any lexical head:

- (35) *Pierre, je l'ai toujours aimé.*
 ‘Pierre, I always liked him.’

In (34), the preposed complement clause ‘that you are a bastard’ is a complement of the lexical head, the matrix verb *somnevat'sja* ‘doubt’. In (4) and (21)–(22), just as in (35) from French, this is not the case: example (22)

contains no matrix verb at all, while in (4), the verb takes no infinitive complements, and in (21), no complements with *čto*.

11. Pragmatic uses and illocutionary uses

It is necessary to say that discourse uses I analyze are in a sense similar to illocutive uses that are described by Sannikov (2005) and Pekelis (2013). Pekelis illustrates this type of uses by examples like:

- (35) *Čtoby by-t' sovsem čestn-ym, ubra-l-Ø tuda že*
 in.order.to be-INF entirely honest-M.SG.INS put-PST-M.SG there PART
i Mar'janin-Ø kletčat-yl čemodan-Ø.
 and Marjana's-M.SG.ACC checkered-M.SG.ACC suitcase-SG.ACC
 ‘To be honest, he also put there Marjana’s suitcase.’ [Владимир Корнилов. Демобилизация (1969—1971)]

Illocutionary uses express semantic relations between the propositional semantics of one clause and the illocutionary force / illocutionary modality of the other. For instance, in (35), the embedded clause with the marker *čtoby* — ‘To be entirely honest’ — is linked to the illocutionary force of the main clause — ‘[I say] that he put there Marjana’s suitcase’. This mechanism contrasts with the canonical use in which the subordinator links the propositional semantics of one clause to the propositional semantics of the other one: in (35), the canonical use would yield the reading ‘He put there Marjana’s suitcase, in order (for him) to be honest’, which is certainly not the thing the author wanted to say.

Pragmatic uses and illocutionary uses have common features. They share the fact that the link between the propositional semantics of two clauses, explaining the canonical use of subordination markers, does not explain either of these two uses. However, while in the illocutionary uses, the propositional semantics of one clause is linked to the illocutionary force of the other, in the topicalized use, the correlation is only between topic / focus components, the subordinate clause being a topic. The illocutionary force is not relevant in the case under analysis.

12. Conclusions

It turns out that the three main types of Russian complement clauses can be used in the topic position. In these uses, they tend to be situated before the

main clause which, in general, is not characteristic of standard uses of complement clauses. The reason is that in canonical syntactic uses, the length and syntactic complexity of complement clauses prevent them from being located before the main verb: it would make the processing of the high-level constituents much longer.

By contrast, in the topicalizing use, the information structure change (namely, the topic introduction) is the main feature of the complement clause, its subordinate status being not critically important. This is why, being similar to an independent clause, it does not directly participate in the processing of the whole construction. The topical status being a strong factor of the position in the beginning of the sentence, clauses of this type often precede the matrix verb.

Each complementizer gets some non-standard features when used in the topic position: in particular, this concerns combinational properties. All complement types under analysis are possible in the topic position, even if the second part either does not contain a complement-taking predicate or contains a predicate that does not take the particular complement type in the standard construction. At the same time, no complementizer entirely loses its grammatical and semantic properties in the pragmatic use. For instance, in constructions with *čto*, the situation is presupposed to take place or is considered to take place. This semantics is not the same as in the standard construction but goes back to standard uses, which often express epistemic meanings but never or almost never express subjective modality. Topicalization changes the semantics of being known to the meaning of 'being known but irrelevant'. Thus, semantics of markers in the topic position is partly derivable from the canonical complementizer use, though its combinational properties change significantly.

The behavior of complement clause in the topic position differs from that of noun phrases. NPs are topicalized either in the form assigned by the head or in the basic (nominative) form. By contrast, or topicalization of clauses, several formal mechanisms are possible, which denote different epistemic status (reality) and pragmatic status of the situation.

Abbreviations

1 — 1st person; 3 — 3rd person; ACC — accusative; COMP — complementizer; DAT — dative; F — feminine; FUT — future; GEN — genitive; INF — infinitive; INS — instrumental case; IRR — irrealis; LOC — locative; M — masculine; N — neuter; NEG — nega-

tion; NOM — nominative; PART — particle; PL — plural; PRS — present; PST — past; Q — question; REFL — reflexive; SG — singular.

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